

RSS Feeds for Google Search

How about monitoring Google search results for a particular query in your favorite RSS News Reader?
<http://dgit.in/MQgFBB>

**TV not on the cards**

According to an Apple executive, Eddy Cue, Apple may not enter the TV space till they created a great user experience and fix existing issues

Top Digital Tools For Entrepreneurs

Whether you're a brick and mortar startup or a cutting edge web technology idea waiting to become the next best thing, these tools will get you off the ground in no time

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Have you noticed the number of new websites you keep hearing of these days? Whether it's a quirky service that'll deliver essentials to your doorstep in the wee hours or a niche shopping site that only sells bags – ideas and in turn budding entrepreneurs are cropping up faster than err mould on damp bread. Gross analogies aside, you must've sensed the startup culture in the air (unless of course you've been hiding under the proverbial rock). The atmosphere is almost palpable and more and more entrepreneurs are being driven to do their own thing. If you too have had an idea buzzing in your cranium and want to do something about it, but don't know where to start, here are some tools to get you on your way.

1. The basics

For any business, the basics need to be taken care of at the outset. What do you need? You need a domain for your idea. Whether if only to host an "under construction" board or simply to get yourself an @yourbusiness.com email idea, buying a domain name is essential. It gives a digital identity to your venture. Perhaps the best way to get yourself a domain is through Google Apps. You can register a new domain starting from \$8 a year and with it you get Google Apps support for upto 10 users - that means Email, Calendar and Google Docs all bundled. Of course you could register a domain name from anywhere, but doing it with Google, just get's you preconfig-

ured email in a format that you're probably familiar with. Head over to <http://goo.gl/Xokl5> to get started.

2. Create your presence

Once your identity is established, you need a presence. The digital personality equivalent of your business in the virtual world is a website. To get your website up you need two things – space to host the website and the website itself. Space can be bought from re-sellers such as <http://www.bigrock.in/> and <http://www.hostgator.in/> have attractive offers going on. If you have questions about hosting, they have toll-free numbers and live-chat help to clear your doubts. While choosing a hosting service choose one that has maximum data uptime guarantee. Also things to keep in mind include, bandwidth restrictions (if any) payment options, take a demo of the control panel, and check for Fantastico support.

Now comes the part of making a website. "Coding, webdesigners, hassles" is what you're thinking right? You needn't fret. Services such as www.moonfruit.com and www.weebly.com allow you to build websites with drag and drop ease for free. Some amount of website design and deployment is even offered by hosting services for a small premium.

Think you can get your hands dirty? Wordpress is the way to go. Wordpress is easy to deploy (many hosting services such as BigRock provide one click installation) and while initially intended as a blogging platform it's a great way to build no fuss, ultra-cool websites even for businesses. Not only creation, management too is a breeze – creating a new page, new menu item, integrating analytics,



translating your page into different languages basically anything you can think of, is made available to you through the dashboard and wordpress plugin repository. So creating an about page, services page, etc., is quite easy. Here are some nice free business themes to get you started – <http://dgit.in/NitWi5>

3. Get funding

Getting funding until recently meant sucking up to that rich uncle or pandering to a bunch of angel investors who eventually turn out to be not so angelic. With the ushering of crowdfunding the game has changed. Kickstarter.com (and few clones) allow you to present your business idea, expansion plan, or service to regular folks who buy into it. Backers to your idea can pledge anywhere between \$5 to literally thousands of dollars. And why would people do that? Be warned these pledges are not necessarily donations, they're more like pre-bookings in most cases. You need to obviously offer people a hook to buy into your idea. This can be an acknowledgement in the form of a mention in the product sheet, a thank you note, a visit to your facility, something named after them (for high-value pledgers), a limited edition product SKU or even a free T-shirt!

To start a project on Kickstarter you need a clear pitch, an explanatory video and incentive plan for investors. Does the Indian regulatory framework allow you to source funds from the crowd? The concept is pretty new and we all know the breakneck speed with which regulators react to change. But fear not we saw a few